Task 3 - Questions and Report

Project: Document Management System (DMS)

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Section 1: Open Questions (Interview) - 10 Questions

Q1. How do you currently store and organize documents in the office?

Answer: Most documents are in paper folders in cabinets. Some are on personal computers and flash drives, and others are email attachments. There is no fixed rule for file names or folders.

Q2. Describe how you find a document when someone asks for it.

Answer: I check the cabinets first, then the computer folders, and then my email. Sometimes it takes 15 to 30 minutes, and sometimes I cannot find it.

Q3. What are the biggest problems you face with the current way of working?

Answer: Lost papers, different versions of the same file, and slow approvals. We also repeat work because we cannot find old documents.

Q4. How are documents approved and signed today?

Answer: The paper is carried between offices for signatures. A document can wait for several days if the signer is away.

Q5. How do you share documents with colleagues?

Answer: By email, flash drives or printed copies. Sometimes two people edit different copies of the same file.

Q6. What happens when a document is lost or changed by mistake?

Answer: We ask the sender for another copy or write it again. There is no way to know who changed it or what the old version was.

Q7. Who can see or change documents today, and how is this controlled?

Answer: It is not controlled. Anyone who can reach the cabinet or the computer can open the files, and private documents are kept with normal ones.

Q8. What features would you like in a new system?

Answer: One central place for all documents, fast search, version history, different permissions for each user, an approval process and a record of who did what.

Q9. How do you feel about changing to a new system?

Answer: I am happy to change because the current way wastes time, but I am worried about how long it will take to learn the new system.

Q10. What would make the new system successful in your opinion?

Answer: It must be easy to use, fast and secure. Staff need training, and someone must be available to help when there is a problem.

Section 2: Closed Questions (Web Form)

https://docs.google.com/forms/d/e/1FAIpQLSdKN7vWt61YUeW0oA9zs0RCroo6MCIo16hQkPucrT608QPf6A/viewform?usp=dialog

Report

1. Interview Opinion

The interviewee (an administrative staff member) gave these opinions:

- The current way of storing documents is slow and not organized. Documents are in too many places and there is no standard for naming or filing them.
- Paper approvals are too slow and sometimes stop completely when the signer is away.
- The current way is not secure, because private documents are not separated and anyone can open them.
- A central system with fast search is the most valuable improvement, followed by version history and an approval process.
- The new system must be easy to use, and the staff need at least one training session.
- Management support and a person who can help users are needed for the system to succeed.

2. Interview Feelings

From the way the interviewee answered, the following feelings were clear:

Feeling	**What caused it**
Frustration	Long searches for documents and repeating work because old files cannot be found.
Stress	Worry that a lost or wrong version of a document will cause a mistake or a delay in work.
Concern	Private documents are stored without protection and nobody knows who opened or changed them.
Uncertainty	Not sure how long it will take to learn a new system.
Hope	Believes a central system will save time and make daily work easier.

3. Current State of the System

The office works with a manual and scattered system. The table summarizes how each area works today.

Area	**Current situation**
Storage	Paper folders, personal computers, flash drives and email attachments. No central place.
Searching	Manual search in cabinets, folders and email. Takes 15 to 30 minutes and may fail.
Versions	No version control. Several copies of the same file exist and the latest one is unclear.
Sharing	By email, flash drive or printed copy.
Approval	Paper signatures carried between offices; takes several days.
Security	No access control; private and normal documents are kept together.
Backup and recovery	No regular backup. Lost or damaged paper documents cannot be recovered.
Tracking	No record of who opened, changed or deleted a document.

Strengths: the staff know the current way and it needs no extra cost. Weaknesses: it wastes time, causes lost and duplicated documents, and gives no security or history. Overall, the current system does not meet the needs of the office.

4. System Goals

No.	Goal	Problem it solves
1	Store all documents in one central, secure place.	Documents scattered in many places.
2	Let users find any document in seconds by title, category, date or keyword.	Searches that take 15 to 30 minutes.
3	Keep a version history for every document.	Confusion about the latest version.
4	Give each user only the permissions they need (admin, employee, viewer).	No control over who sees or changes documents.
5	Provide a simple online approval process.	Slow paper approvals.
6	Record all activity (open, change, delete) in a log.	No history of changes.
7	Make regular backups and allow recovery.	Lost or damaged documents.
8	Provide an easy-to-use interface that needs little training.	Fear of the new system and long learning time.
9	Reduce paper use and printing.	Cost and space of paper files.